

Curb

Brand Mark — Final Specification

Logo design rationale, usage guidelines, and implementation spec



THE CONCEPT

The mark is a single continuous stroke that reads instantly as the letter "C" — for Curb — while doubling as a literal route: a path that descends, turns, and arrives at a destination, marked by a small dot. It works as a letterform and as a piece of iconography simultaneously, which is what makes it memorable rather than purely decorative.

This dual reading matters because Curb is fundamentally about getting from job to job — the mark embodies that without needing words.

Design Rationale

Why this mark, and what was rejected along the way

WHAT WE STARTED WITH

Early concepts included a literal curb cross-section, a generic spark/lightning icon (borrowed from Lucide, used as a placeholder throughout development), a house/roofline shape, a map pin, and a plain bold letter "C." Each was tested against three criteria: does it survive at 20px (notification icon size), does it feel ownable rather than borrowed from another app in this category, and does it connect conceptually to what Curb actually does.

WHY THE PLAIN "C" WASN'T ENOUGH

A bold letterform C was the early frontrunner — clean, scalable, easy to produce. But it had no story. Anyone could own a letter C. There was no moment of recognition, nothing that made it specifically Curb's mark rather than a placeholder any company could use.

THE FIX — A DOUBLE READING

The final mark keeps the legibility of the C — it still reads instantly as a letterform at a glance — but the stroke doesn't just curve closed. It descends and flattens into a horizontal line capped with a small dot. Read one way, it's a C. Read another way, it's a route: a path with a turn, ending at a stop. The two readings reinforce each other rather than compete.

REFINEMENTS MADE

- Rebalanced vertical proportions — the original draft was bottom-heavy, with more negative space above the curve than below. The final version is optically centered.
- Added a destination dot to cap the open line end. Without it, the stroke read as unfinished rather than intentional. The dot also reinforces the "route to a stop" reading.
- Verified legibility at 32px and 20px — real iPhone Spotlight-search and notification sizes, not just the large preview size designs are usually judged at.
- Built standalone (unboxed) versions in both orange-on-light and sand-on-dark, since the mark needs to work on invoices, favicons, and dark headers without always sitting inside the rounded-square app icon container.

Color Variants

Five approved variants for different contexts



Primary

Orange box, sand mark
App icon, light contexts

Inverted

Dark box, orange mark
Light backgrounds wanting
contrast

Standalone — orange

No container
Invoices, letterhead, favicons
on light bg



Standalone — sand

No container
Dark headers, footers, splash
screens

Watermark

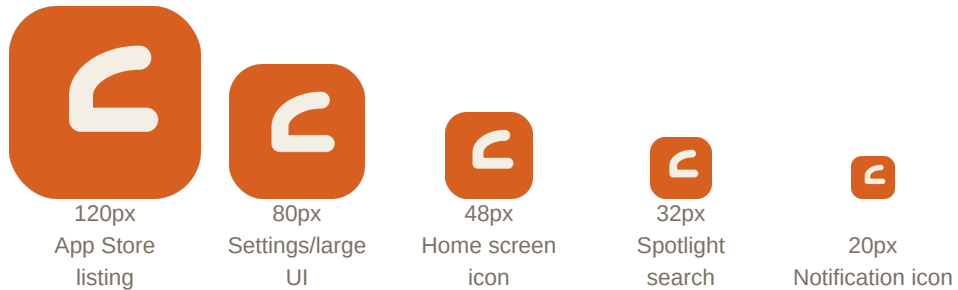
15% opacity, white
Empty states, loading screens,
backgrounds

USAGE RULES

- Never recolor the mark outside the approved palette (Curb Orange #D75F1F, Sand #F4EFE4, Asphalt #1D1A16).
- Never stretch or distort the proportions — the mark is built on a 56×56 grid; scale uniformly only.
- Minimum clear space around the mark equals the height of the dot accent on all sides.
- Minimum size: 20px. Below that, use the wordmark alone or omit the mark entirely.
- On photography or busy backgrounds, always use the boxed (primary) variant for contrast.

Scalability Test

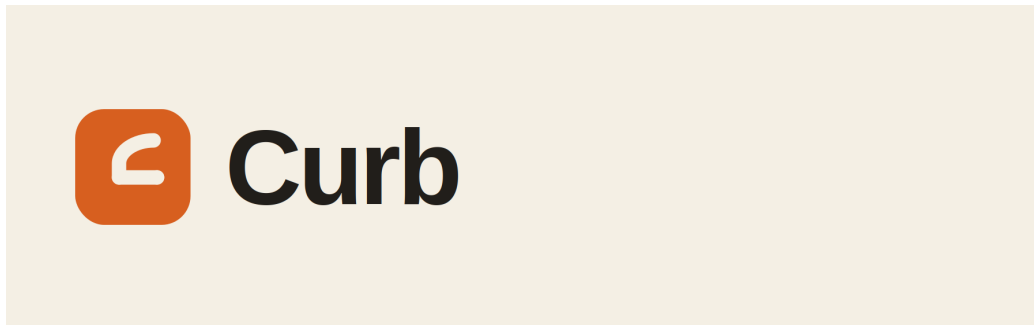
The mark verified at every real-world size it will actually appear at



The destination dot at the end of the stroke is what keeps the mark legible at the smallest sizes — without it, the open line end would dissolve into ambiguity below roughly 28px. Verified down to 20px without loss of recognizability.

Wordmark Lockup

Mark + type, for headers, splash screens, and marketing



TYPOGRAPHY

Wordmark typeface is **Bricolage Grotesque**, weight 800 (ExtraBold), with tight letter-spacing (-0.03em). This is the same display typeface used throughout the app for headings, numbers, and the home-screen greeting — the wordmark should never use a different font than the product itself.

Note: this PDF approximates the wordmark in a system sans-serif font because Bricolage Grotesque is a webfont and isn't available in this PDF-rendering environment. The actual app and website both load it correctly from Google Fonts — see the [implementation brief](#) for the exact import.

Implementation Spec

Exact SVG markup, ready to hand to engineering

PRIMARY MARK (boxed, for app icon)

```
<svg width="56" height="56" viewBox="0 0 56 56">
  <rect width="56" height="56" rx="14" fill="#D75F1F"/>
  <path d="M38 15 C29 15 21 20 21 26 L21 33"
        stroke="#F4EFE4" stroke-width="7"
        stroke-linecap="round" fill="none"/>
  <path d="M21 33 L40 33"
        stroke="#F4EFE4" stroke-width="7"
        stroke-linecap="round"/>
  <circle cx="40" cy="33" r="3.5" fill="#F4EFE4"/>
</svg>
```

STANDALONE MARK — ORANGE (no container, for light backgrounds)

```
<svg width="56" height="56" viewBox="0 0 56 56">
  <path d="M38 15 C29 15 21 20 21 26 L21 33"
        stroke="#D75F1F" stroke-width="7"
        stroke-linecap="round" fill="none"/>
  <path d="M21 33 L40 33"
        stroke="#D75F1F" stroke-width="7"
        stroke-linecap="round"/>
  <circle cx="40" cy="33" r="3.5" fill="#D75F1F"/>
</svg>
```

STANDALONE MARK — SAND (no container, for dark backgrounds)

```
<svg width="56" height="56" viewBox="0 0 56 56">
  <path d="M38 15 C29 15 21 20 21 26 L21 33"
        stroke="#F4EFE4" stroke-width="7"
        stroke-linecap="round" fill="none"/>
  <path d="M21 33 L40 33"
        stroke="#F4EFE4" stroke-width="7"
        stroke-linecap="round"/>
  <circle cx="40" cy="33" r="3.5" fill="#F4EFE4"/>
</svg>
```

COLOR REFERENCE

Token	Hex	Usage
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Curb Orange	#D75F1F	Primary mark, accent, brand color
Sand	#F4EFE4	Mark on dark, app background
Asphalt	#1D1A16	Dark box variant, headers